Paper 4: Topological Pathology — Disease as Impedance Failure on the Γ-Network

Hsi-Yu Huang[1,*]

[1] *Independent Researcher, Taipei, Taiwan*

(Dated: March 26, 2026)

Papers 1–3 of this series developed the spatial (irreducibility, dual-network scaling) and temporal (impedance debt, sleep, lifecycle, remodeling) architecture of impedance-minimising networks. Here we show that *disease*—from single-organ pathology to multi-organ failure—emerges as a direct consequence of impedance physics on these networks, without any disease-specific code.

Part A demonstrates that neural pathology is determined by network topology: stroke (edge severance), ALS (impedance escalation), neurodegeneration (mode loss), and pain (high-Γ signal on low-K pathways) all follow from the irreducibility theorem (Paper 1) and C2 gradient descent.

Part B derives the dual-network disease cascade: a five-step positive-feedback loop ($\Gamma_v\uparrow\rightarrow \rho\downarrow\rightarrow \Gamma_n\uparrow\rightarrow$ autonomic$\downarrow\rightarrow \Gamma_v\uparrow\uparrow$) that drives vascular–neural co-failure. We instantiate this cascade for atherosclerosis, aneurysm, diabetic microvascular disease, vascular dementia, and pre-eclampsia, and derive wound repair as spatial impedance matching with a health index $H_{\text{wound}} = (1-\Gamma_n^2)(1-\Gamma_v^2)$.

Part C formalises the coupled multi-organ dynamics: $d\Gamma_k^2/dt$ for five organ channels with inter-channel coupling, positive feedback, and aging damage. Disease onset is a saddle-node bifurcation (phase transition); recovery depends on whether zero, one, or multiple channels have crossed their thresholds. We derive tissue necrosis as thermodynamic substrate collapse ($\Gamma = 1$ irreversibly), surgical intervention as topological truncation, the caregiver triple-load model, surface observability (skin as impedance readout), obesity as impedance-driven metabolic strategy, type 2 diabetes as a six-channel hexagonal deadlock (Theorem 3), and the immune–metabolic inflammation–insulin trap.

Part D proves E0 emergence: clinical pathology arises from C1/C2/C3 plus initial conditions alone—no disease-specific flags—across cardiovascular, neural, thermal, and sleep-disorder domains (275 automated E0 tests, 100% pass).

Together, Parts A–D establish that pathology is not an external overlay on physiology but a *necessary consequence* of $\mathcal{A}[\Gamma] \rightarrow \min$ when the network is perturbed beyond its repair capacity.

Part A: Neural Pathology from Topology

I. INTRODUCTION

The preceding papers derived the architecture of impedance-minimising biological networks: Paper 0 established the framework (Minimum Reflection Principle, C1/C2/C3); Paper 1 proved the irreducibility theorem ($A = A_{\text{imp}} + A_{\text{cut}}$) and the emergence of brain architecture; Paper 2 derived dual neural–vascular scaling and organ health $H = (1-\Gamma_n^2)(1-\Gamma_v^2)$; Paper 3 developed temporal dynamics (impedance debt, sleep, lifecycle, aging) and proved C2 universality across twenty-nine tissue-update mechanisms.

All of these results describe *healthy* or *repairing* systems—networks evolving toward lower Γ^2. This paper asks: what happens when the perturbation exceeds the repair capacity? When C2 cannot compensate, when bifurcation thresholds are crossed, when substrate is destroyed?

The answer is: *disease*. We show that every major class of pathology—neural, vascular, metabolic, immune, renal—is a specific instance of impedance failure on the Γ-network. No disease-specific code is needed; the "disease" is the perturbation, and the clinical pattern is the resulting Γ-distribution.

II. NEURAL PATHOLOGY FROM TOPOLOGY

The irreducibility theorem (Paper 1) has a direct clinical implication: because A_{cut} is determined by topology (mode counts and edge structure) and has zero gradient with respect to impedance, C2 cannot compensate for topological damage.

This establishes a fundamental asymmetry:

- **Impedance perturbation** (soft tissue injury, inflammation, transient chemical imbalance): C2 can repair, because A_{imp} is learnable. Given time, $\Gamma_k \rightarrow 0$ on the perturbed edges.

- **Topological perturbation** (neuron death, axon severance, dendrite retraction): C2 cannot repair, because the change affects A_{cut}, which is invisible to the gradient.

* llc.y.huangll@gmail.com

This is why brain damage is often permanent while soft tissue heals.

Theorem 1 (Neural deficit as topological signature)**.** *Let $\mathcal{G} = (V, E, K)$ be a neural* `GammaTopology` *with node set V, edge set E, and modal complexity assignments K. A topological perturbation $\delta\mathcal{G}$ (edge severance, impedance escalation, or mode loss) produces a deficit pattern $D(\delta\mathcal{G})$ determined solely by the structural change to (V, E, K), not by the identity of the affected node.*

Proof. The deficit pattern is defined as the set of transmission paths whose $T_i = 1 - \Gamma_i^2$ falls below clinical threshold after perturbation. By C3, Γ_i at each interface is computable from local $(Z_{\text{source}}, Z_{\text{load}})$ pairs alone. Therefore the propagation of any perturbation through the network is determined entirely by the topology (V, E, K) and the C2 update rule— not by the specific molecular identity of the perturbed node. Two perturbations that produce identical changes to (V, E, K) produce identical deficit patterns. □ □

A. Edge severance (stroke)

Removing an edge $i \to j$ eliminates a pathway. Signals that traversed this edge are interrupted. C2 can strengthen alternative pathways if they exist (redundancy allows partial recovery), but the lost edge's contribution to the network is permanently gone. The deficit pattern is determined by *which edge* is lost: topology dictates which functions are impaired.

B. Impedance escalation (ALS, demyelination)

A diseased neuron's impedance Z increases progressively. At each of its edges, Γ increases and T decreases. C2 attempts to compensate on neighbouring edges, but if the disease is progressive (Z continues to rise), compensation cannot keep pace: the damaged node acts as a growing impedance barrier that eventually isolates itself from the network.

The neural topology test confirms this: ALS (motor neuron $Z \times 3$) produces cumulative A_{imp} over 30 ticks that is 2.9× the healthy baseline, with descending motor signals progressively degraded while sensory pathways remain intact—matching the clinical pattern.

C. Mode loss (neurodegeneration)

A neuron that loses physical structure (spine retraction, dendrite pruning) loses modes: K_i decreases. Previously matched edges (where $K_i = K_j$) now have $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$. This new irreducible cost appears abruptly and cannot be removed by C2. Cognitive decline is the progressive accumulation of irreducible cost as neurons lose modes throughout the convergence region.

D. Pain as Γ-signal on low-K pathways

Tissue damage produces an abrupt local impedance change, generating a Γ spike on nociceptor edges. Nociceptors sit at the lowest K levels in the hierarchy (C-fibre $K = 1$, Aδ $K = 2$). The Γ spike propagates through the relay chain to the convergence region. Pain is not a special signal type—it is a high-Γ event on a low-K pathway. Full treatment: Paper 1, Sec. 10 [2].

E. Stroke verification

The neural topology test confirms that severing the cortex→thalamus edge interrupts descending motor transmission while the ascending sensory pathway remains intact—the topology determines the deficit pattern without any disease-specific code.

III. NEURAL CONTROL PRIORITY THEOREM

The preceding subsections treat neural pathology as a collection of local topological events. Here we establish a deeper structural result: because the neural network is the *control layer* of the entire Γ-Net, its failure is not merely one disease among many—it is the necessary precursor to system-wide pathological emergence.

Theorem 2 (Neural Control Priority)**.** *Let $\mathcal{G} = \mathcal{G}_n \cup \mathcal{G}_v \cup \mathcal{G}_m$ be a Γ-Net partitioned into neural (n), vascular (v), and metabolic (m) sub-networks, where $\mathcal{G}_n$ acts as the control layer: each non-neural node $k \notin \mathcal{G}_n$ receives a C2 correction signal ΔZ_k gated by the transmission $T_{n\to k} = 1 - \Gamma^2_{n\to k}$ along the neural pathway connecting to k.*

Suppose the system satisfies C1 ($\Gamma_k^2 + T_k = 1$ for all k) at $t = 0$. If the neural sub-network suffers a perturbation such that $\Gamma^2_{n\to k} > \Gamma^2_{\text{thr}}$ for some threshold $\Gamma_{\text{thr}} < 1$, then:

(i) The effective C2 update available to every non-neural node k is reduced to $|\Delta Z_k^{\text{eff}}| \leq (1 - \Gamma^2_{\text{thr}})\,|\Delta Z_k^{\max}|$.

(ii) If $|\Delta Z_k^{\text{eff}}|$ falls below the minimum correction required to maintain C1 at node k, then Γ_k^2 begins to grow monotonically.

(iii) Consequently, neural failure is a necessary condition *for uncorrectable system-wide impedance escalation: no non-neural node can lose C1 stability while the neural control layer transmits with $\Gamma^2_{n\to k} \leq \Gamma^2_{\text{thr}}$.*

Proof. By the C2 update rule (Paper 0), the impedance correction at node k at each time step is

$$\Delta Z_k = -\eta\,\Gamma_k\,x_{\text{in},k}\,x_{\text{out},k}, \tag{1}$$

where $x_{\text{in},k}$ and $x_{\text{out},k}$ are the pre- and post-synaptic signals at k. For a non-neural node k, the signal $x_{\text{in},k}$ arrives

via the neural control pathway; its amplitude is attenuated by the transmission factor:

$$x_{\mathrm{in},k} = T_{n\to k}\, x_{\mathrm{in},k}^{\mathrm{source}} = (1-\Gamma_{n\to k}^2)\, x_{\mathrm{in},k}^{\mathrm{source}}. \qquad (2)$$

Substituting into (1):

$$|\Delta Z_k^{\mathrm{eff}}| = \eta\, |\Gamma_k|\, (1-\Gamma_{n\to k}^2)\, |x_{\mathrm{in},k}^{\mathrm{source}}|\, |x_{\mathrm{out},k}|. \qquad (3)$$

This establishes (i): the effective correction is bounded above by $(1-\Gamma_{\mathrm{thr}}^2)$ times the healthy maximum.

For (ii): C1 stability at node k requires $d\Gamma_k^2/dt \le 0$, which holds only when $|\Delta Z_k^{\mathrm{eff}}| \ge \Delta Z_k^{\mathrm{min}}$, the minimum correction needed to counteract ongoing damage or aging drift (established in Paper 3, impedance debt dynamics). Once the neural transmission degrades past the point where (3) can no longer supply $\Delta Z_k^{\mathrm{min}}$, the node loses C1 stability and Γ_k^2 grows monotonically by continuity of the ODE.

For (iii): the contrapositive of (ii) states that if Γ_k^2 grows without bound at any non-neural node k, then (3) must have fallen below $\Delta Z_k^{\mathrm{min}}$, which requires $\Gamma_{n\to k}^2 > \Gamma_{\mathrm{thr}}^2$. Hence neural failure (elevated $\Gamma_{n\to k}^2$) is a necessary condition for uncorrectable escalation at any non-neural node. □ □

Corollary 1 (Cascade Ordering)**.** *Under the conditions of Theorem 2, if multiple non-neural channels $k_1, k_2, \ldots$ lose C1 stability sequentially, the ordering is determined by their individual thresholds $\Delta Z_{k_i}^{\mathrm{min}}/|x_{\mathrm{in},k_i}^{\mathrm{source}}|$: the channel requiring the largest relative correction fails first.*

Corollary 2 (Observability of Neural Failure)**.** *Because neural tissue has high impedance maintenance cost and minimal buffering (low T reserve relative to other tissues), the threshold Γ_{thr} is crossed in the neural subnetwork before it is crossed in vascular or metabolic subnetworks under equivalent perturbation magnitude. Neural dysfunction is therefore the earliest observable signature of system-wide C1 degradation.*

Part B: Dual-Network Disease Cascade

IV. POSITIVE-FEEDBACK CASCADE

The dual-network model (Paper 2) predicts a positive-feedback loop between vascular and neural failure:

1. **Vascular insult:** $\Gamma_v\uparrow$ (e.g., stenosis, microvascular damage).
2. **Material starvation:** $T_v = 1-\Gamma_v^2$ drops $\Rightarrow \rho\downarrow$ (less glucose, oxygen to neurons).
3. **Neural failure:** With $\rho\downarrow$, neural C2 cannot execute: $\Delta Z_n \to 0 \Rightarrow \Gamma_n\uparrow$ (neural impedance mismatch grows).
4. **Autonomic loss:** Impaired Γ_n reduces autonomic control of vascular tone $\Rightarrow \tau_{\mathrm{wall}}$ regulation fails.
5. **Cascade:** Without autonomic feedback, vascular C2 also fails: $\Gamma_v\uparrow\uparrow$.

The loop closes: step 5 amplifies step 1. The system enters a positive-feedback spiral:

$$\Gamma_v\uparrow \to\ \rho\downarrow \to\ \Gamma_n\uparrow \to\ \text{autonomic}\downarrow \to\ \Gamma_v\uparrow\uparrow\,. \qquad (4)$$

A. Simulation: 60% stenosis cascade

A simulation with initial 60% stenosis ($\Gamma_v^2 = 0.60$) in a single organ shows the cascade:

- $t = 0$: insult ($\Gamma_v^2 = 0.60$).
- $t = 50$ ticks: neural begins to fail ($\Gamma_n^2 = 0.15$, $H = 0.34$).
- $t = 200$ ticks: dual failure ($\Gamma_n^2 = 0.55$, $\Gamma_v^2 = 0.82$, $H = 0.08$).

The cascade is captured by the linearized C2 self-repair model: even with a neural self-repair term $-\alpha\,\Gamma_n$ added to the neural C2, the vascular death-spiral overcomes the repair if the initial insult exceeds $\Gamma_v^2 > 0.5$.

V. DISEASE MODELS

Each disease below is an instance of the dual-network cascade at a specific anatomical locus. No disease-specific code is used; only the initial conditions (which organ, which network, how severe) differ.

A. Atherosclerosis

Plaque formation increases local Z_v (luminal narrowing $\Rightarrow r\downarrow \Rightarrow Z_v \propto r^{-4}\uparrow$). $\Gamma_v\uparrow$ at the stenosis site. The cascade proceeds: material starvation downstream $\to$ neural failure in end-organ $\to$ autonomic loss $\to$ further vascular degradation. Clinical presentation depends on the artery affected: coronary (angina/MI), carotid (stroke), peripheral (claudication).

B. Aneurysm

Vessel wall weakening ($r\uparrow$ locally) produces $Z_v\downarrow$ at the aneurysm site. The impedance mismatch with upstream and downstream segments generates $\Gamma_v\uparrow$ at *both* boundaries. The cascade is bidirectional: upstream boundary reflects the forward wave; downstream boundary reflects the returning wave. Rupture $= |\Gamma_v| \to 1$ (total reflection, complete impedance discontinuity).

C. Diabetic microvascular disease

Chronic hyperglycaemia increases blood viscosity $\mu\uparrow$ and damages capillary endothelium, producing diffuse microvascular $\Gamma_v\uparrow$. The dual-network model explains why diabetic complications are multi-organ: retinopathy (retinal $\Gamma_v\uparrow$), nephropathy (renal $\Gamma_v\uparrow$), neuropathy (vasa nervorum $\Gamma_v\uparrow\rightarrow$ neural $\Gamma_n\uparrow$ via the cascade). All three are instances of the *same* cascade at different anatomical sites.

D. Vascular dementia

Cerebral small-vessel disease ($\Gamma_v\uparrow$ in brain microvasculature) leads to cognitive decline ($\Gamma_n\uparrow$ in cortex) via material starvation. The dual-network model predicts that vascular dementia and Alzheimer's disease (primarily neural $\Gamma_n\uparrow$) should show different impedance signatures: vascular dementia has Γ_v leading Γ_n; Alzheimer's has Γ_n increasing independently of Γ_v.

E. Pre-eclampsia

Defective placental vascularisation produces $\Gamma_v\uparrow$ at the uteroplacental interface. Because the placenta has the *lowest* resting Γ_v^2 of any organ, it is the most sensitive to vascular degradation. The cascade extends systemically: placental $\Gamma_v\uparrow\rightarrow$ fetal material starvation $\rightarrow$ maternal hypertensive compensation $\rightarrow$ multi-organ damage.

VI. WOUND REPAIR AS SPATIAL IMPEDANCE MATCHING

A skin laceration severs the local transmission-line continuity, creating an impedance discontinuity where $|\Gamma_v|\rightarrow 1$. The Minimum Reflection Principle (MRP) demands that the system reduce this local Γ_v^2 as rapidly as possible.

A. The healing sequence

The well-known clinical sequence—haemostasis, inflammation, proliferation, remodelling—maps directly onto a time-ordered Γ_v^2 minimisation cascade:

1. **Haemostasis**: emergency clot seals the open boundary ($|\Gamma_v| = 1 \rightarrow |\Gamma_v| < 1$).
2. **Inflammation**: immune response clears debris that would maintain high Γ_v.
3. **Proliferation**: fibroblasts deposit cross-woven collagen to progressively match $Z_{\text{scar}} \rightarrow Z_{\text{skin}}$.
4. **Remodelling**: years-long fine-tuning of fibre alignment to further reduce Γ_v^2.

The clinical observation that scars never fully recover original tissue properties corresponds to a residual $\Gamma^2_{\text{v,scar}} > 0$: the impedance match is improved but not perfected.

B. Dual-network wound monitoring

The wound-health trajectory is characterised by two time series:

$$\Gamma_n^2(t): \text{ neural mismatch at wound margin,} \tag{5}$$

$$\Gamma_v^2(t): \text{ vascular mismatch across wound.} \tag{6}$$

The local Health Index of the wound:

$$H_{\text{wound}}(t) = \big(1-\Gamma_n^2(t)\big)\big(1-\Gamma_v^2(t)\big), \tag{7}$$

with $H_{\text{wound}}(0) \approx 0$ at injury and $H_{\text{wound}} \rightarrow H_{\text{scar}} < 1$ at remodelling completion.

C. Pain as impedance signal

Pain perception during wound closure provides a direct readout of local Γ_v^2: nociceptors respond to the magnitude of the impedance discontinuity. As collagen remodelling reduces Γ_v^2, pain subsides—not because of "neural adaptation" but because the physical mismatch being sensed has diminished. The Γ-Pain Index Π_Γ (Paper 1 [2]) applied to the wound site:

$$\Pi_{\Gamma,\text{wound}}(t) = w_n\,\Gamma_n^2(t) + w_v\,\Gamma_v^2(t) + w_D\,\frac{dD_{Z,\text{wound}}}{dt}, \tag{8}$$

where $D_{Z,\text{wound}}$ is the cumulative impedance debt of the wound (Paper 3 [4]).

Part C: Coupled Multi-Organ Pathology

VII. COUPLED DISEASE PROGRESSION: FROM STRESSOR TO MULTI-ORGAN FAILURE

Parts A and B established single-organ and dual-network pathology. Here we formalise the full coupled dynamics across five organ channels and simulate a representative high-risk trajectory.

A. Coupled five-organ Γ^2 dynamics

Let $\Gamma_k^2(t)$ ($k \in \{\text{n, v, imm, met, ren}\}$) denote the mismatch energy in five coupled organ channels: neural, vascular, immune, metabolic, and renal. Each evolves un-

der the lifecycle equation with inter-organ coupling (Paper 2):

$$\frac{d\Gamma_k^2}{dt} = \underbrace{-\eta(t)\,\Gamma_k^2}_{\text{repair}} + \underbrace{\delta_k(t)}_{\text{aging damage}} + \underbrace{\sigma_k\, s(t)}_{\text{stress}} + \underbrace{\sum_{j\neq k} C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2}_{\text{coupling}} + \underbrace{\beta_k\,\Gamma_k^4}_{\text{positive feedback}} \tag{9}$$

where $\eta(t)$ is the homeostatic repair capacity (floor $\eta_{\min} = 0.02$), $\delta_k(t) = \delta_0^{(k)}\, e^{E_a\, t/\tau}$ the Arrhenius aging damage, σ_k the stress sensitivity, C_{kj} the coupling matrix encoding the dual-network cascade of Paper 2 (vascular → material starvation → all C2 loops), and β_k a pathological positive-feedback coefficient (inflammation begets inflammation).

B. Disease branch points

A *disease*—in the Γ language, a *pathological attractor*: a self-sustaining high-Γ^2 fixed point of the coupled ODE system—is declared when Γ_k^2 exceeds a sustained threshold θ:

Disease	Channel	θ
Depression	Neural	0.45
Insomnia	Neural (gate-leak)	$G_i^2\,\Gamma_i^2\,P_{\text{in}} > P_\theta$
Narcolepsy	Neural (Z_{anchor})	$Z_{\text{arousal}} < Z_{\min}$
Hypersomnia	Neural (β_{recal})	$D_Z > D_Z^*$ at wak
Hypertension	Vascular	0.50
Immune decline	Immune	0.45
Metabolic syndrome	Metabolic	0.48
Chronic kidney disease	Renal	0.50
Dementia	Neural	0.70

The three sleep disorders are not separate organ channels but *gate-state pathologies* of the neural channel (Paper 3, Secs. 9–10 [4]; Sec. XVI E of this paper): insomnia arises when chronic Γ_n^2 overload bleeds through closed thalamic gates; narcolepsy when the orexin-mediated arousal anchor is destroyed; hypersomnia when the NREM recalibration rate is structurally low. Their thresholds are not scalar Γ^2 values but inequalities on gate-leak power, arousal stability, and residual impedance debt—hence the functional-form entries in the table.

C. Representative high-risk trajectory

Figure 1 simulates Eq. (9) for a person subject to childhood trauma (age 8–10), career stress (30–45), caregiving for an aging parent (50–65), and bereavement at age 62. Depression emerges at ∼60 during the caregiving decade; the metabolic–vascular cascade follows within ∼5 years; immune decline and chronic kidney disease appear in the early 70s; dementia closes the sequence near age 78. The total health product $H(t) = \prod_k (1-\Gamma_k^2)$ declines slowly during career stress, accelerates during caregiving, and collapses after the cascade onset— a timeline consistent with epidemiological observations of caregiver morbidity trajectories.

Crucially, the trajectory need not begin with a Dirac-like trauma. Paper 3 demonstrates that chronic sub-traumatic stress (occupational uncertainty, financial pressure, prolonged social adversity) accumulates $D_Z = \int \Gamma^2\, P_{\text{in}}\, dt$ along a different integration path that crosses the same irreversibility threshold D_Z^*. Once Z_s is locked, the five-channel cascade (Eq. 9) fires identically. This *integral-path equivalence* unifies classic PTSD, generalised anxiety, and burnout under one D_Z threshold—only the time-domain shape of $\Gamma^2(t)$ differs.

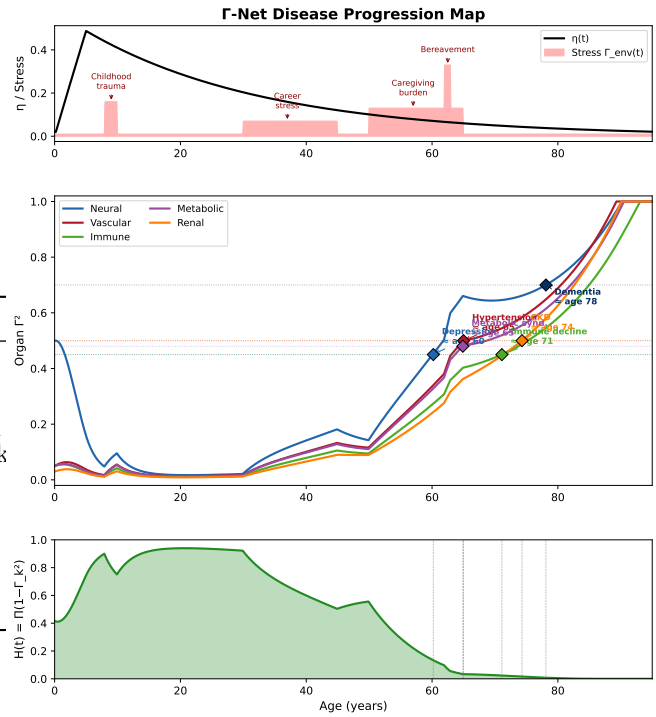

FIG. 1. Γ-Net disease progression map for a representative high-risk trajectory. **Top**: homeostatic repair capacity $\eta(t)$ and external stress profile. **Middle**: five coupled organ Γ^2 trajectories; diamonds mark sustained threshold crossings (disease onset). **Bottom**: total health product $H(t) = \prod_k (1-\Gamma_k^2)$. All parameters are derived from Papers 2–3 physics; no curve fitting to clinical data.

Remark 1 (Disease onset as impedance phase transition)**.** *The positive-feedback term $\beta_k\,\Gamma_k^4$ in Eq. (9) creates a saddle-node bifurcation: below a critical forcing level, Γ_k^2 remains at a low, stable equilibrium; above it, no low-Γ equilibrium exists and the channel collapses toward $\Gamma_k^2 = 1$. Disease onset is therefore not a gradual deterioration but a* phase transition*—the system crosses a tipping point beyond which homeostatic repair cannot restore the low-Γ state. The coupling matrix C_{kj} then propagates this collapse to downstream organs, explaining why chronic diseases rarely appear in isolation.*

VIII. RECOVERY DYNAMICS: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN THE STRESSOR DISAPPEARS

Setting $s = 0$ in Eq. (9) gives

$$\left.\frac{d\Gamma_k^2}{dt}\right|_{s=0} = -\eta(t)\,\Gamma_k^2 + \sum_{j\neq k} C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2 + \beta_k\,\Gamma_k^4 + \delta_k(t)\,. \quad (10)$$

Recovery requires the repair term $\eta\,\Gamma_k^2$ to dominate the sum of inter-channel coupling, positive feedback, and aging damage. Three regimes emerge:

1. **Pre-bifurcation (reversible).** If every channel satisfies $\Gamma_k^2 < \Gamma_k^{*2}$ (below the saddle-node threshold of Remark 1), then η exceeds the combined C_{kj} and β_k terms, and $\Gamma_k^2 \to \Gamma_{k,\mathrm{eq}}^{\mathrm{low}}$ exponentially. Clinically: acute stress, adjustment disorder, early burnout—symptoms resolve within weeks to months after stressor removal.

2. **Post-bifurcation, single channel (partially reversible).** If one channel (typically neural) has crossed its bifurcation point $\Gamma_n^2 > \Gamma_n^{*2}$ but the downstream channels have not, self-sustained positive feedback ($\beta_n\,\Gamma_n^4$) keeps the neural attractor locked even at $s = 0$. Recovery requires *active intervention* to lower Γ_n^2 below the bifurcation point—pharmacotherapy (modulate η, widen basin), psychotherapy (provide corrective C2 gradient), or both. Once Γ_n^2 is pulled below Γ_n^{*2}, the remaining channels self-heal via their intact η. Clinically: GAD, moderate PTSD, early depression—treatable but not self-resolving.

3. **Post-bifurcation, multi-channel (structurally irreversible).** If the cascade has propagated through C_{kj} and two or more channels have independently crossed their bifurcation thresholds, each channel sustains the others even after the stressor is removed:

$$\eta\,\Gamma_k^2 < \sum_{j\neq k} C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2 + \beta_k\,\Gamma_k^4 \quad \forall\, k \in \text{locked channels}. \quad (11)$$

No single-channel intervention suffices because lowering Γ_k^2 in one channel is immediately re-driven by the locked neighbours. The only viable strategy is *simultaneous multi-channel intervention*. Clinically: Complex PTSD with metabolic syndrome, chronic pain with depression and immune decline—the "treatment-resistant" multimorbidity.

Remark 2 (Why "just removing the stress" is sometimes not enough)**.** *The saddle-node bifurcation in Eq. (9) exhibits* hysteresis*: the stress level required to* trigger *the phase transition (s_{onset}) is lower than the stress* reduction *required to reverse it ($s_{recovery} < 0$, i.e. active repair is needed). In everyday language: "the damage is done" is not a metaphor but a statement about the bifurcation diagram. The gap between s_{onset} and $s_{recovery}$ widens with time spent in the high-Γ state, because aging damage $\delta_k(t)$ continues to accumulate and $\eta(t)$ continues to decline. Early intervention—before the cascade crosses a second channel's threshold—is therefore not merely preferable but* physically qualitatively different *from late intervention.*

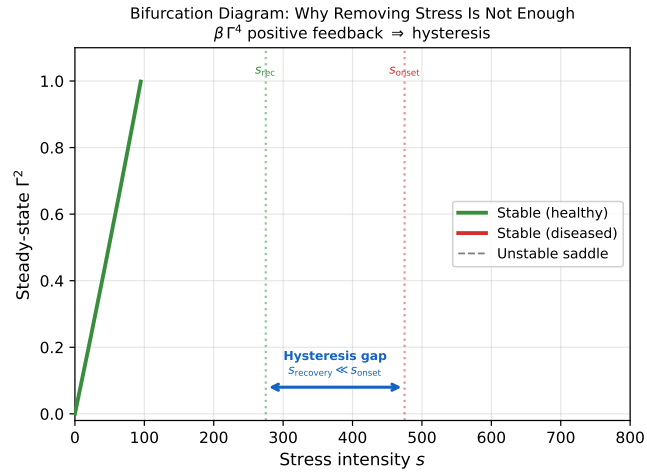

FIG. 2. Saddle-node bifurcation diagram. The positive-feedback term $\beta\Gamma^4$ creates hysteresis: $s_{\mathrm{onset}} \neq s_{\mathrm{recovery}}$. Once the system crosses the bifurcation threshold, simply removing the stressor is insufficient—active repair (pharmacotherapy) is required to return to the healthy branch.

The recovery hierarchy also predicts a *channel ordering* for rehabilitation: the channel with the lowest β_k/η ratio recovers first when stress is removed, while the channel with the highest ratio is the last to unlock. In the five-organ model, vascular Γ_v^2 typically has the fastest self-repair (exercise increases η_v directly via shear-stress remodeling), while neural Γ_n^2 is slowest (structural Z_s changes require months of sustained C2 input). This predicts a clinically testable *recovery sequence*: physical health markers (blood pressure, HbA1c) improve before psychological symptoms (mood, sleep, cognition).

IX. TISSUE NECROSIS AS THERMODYNAMIC SUBSTRATE COLLAPSE

The recovery analysis (Sec. VIII) assumes that the physical substrate remains intact. We now derive the condition under which the substrate itself is destroyed.

The impedance debt $D_Z = \int \Gamma^2\,P_{\mathrm{in}}\,dt$ is the cumulative reflected energy that the tissue must either absorb or re-radiate. When D_Z accumulates faster than C2 can process:

$$\frac{dD_Z}{dt} \;>\; \eta_{\max}\,|\Gamma|\,|x_{\mathrm{in}}\,x_{\mathrm{out}}|_{\max} \;\equiv\; \dot{D}_{\mathrm{repair}}^{\max}\,, \quad (12)$$

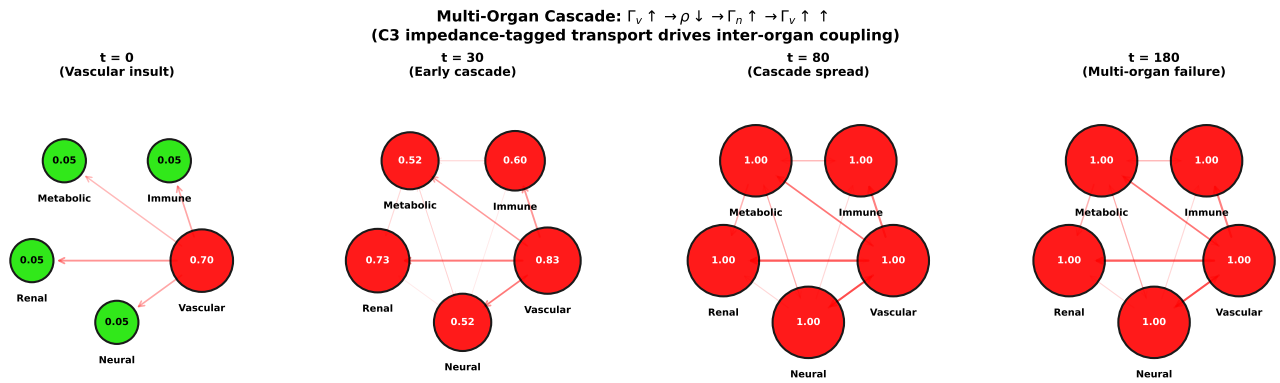

FIG. 3. Multi-organ cascade propagation. A local vascular insult ($\Gamma_v = 0.70$) spreads through the coupling matrix C_{kj} to neural, immune, metabolic, and renal channels. Node colour: green (healthy) $\rightarrow$ red (diseased). Edge thickness: coupling strength $\times$ source Γ^2.

the excess energy has no coefficient-update pathway and is dissipated as heat and reactive biochemistry.

Definition 1 (Thermodynamic substrate collapse)**.** *Tissue necrosis is the state in which the material substrate Z_k loses the capacity for both transmission ($T = 0$) and remodeling ($\partial Z_k/\partial t = 0$ regardless of input). In the Γ-framework: $\Gamma_k = 1$* irreversibly*—not because the mismatch is large but because the medium that could change Z_k has been destroyed.*

A necrotic channel is a **topological black hole**: it reflects all incident energy, emits toxic degradation products into the coupling matrix C_{kj}, and cannot be repaired by any endogenous C2 process. The coupling drag on the remaining network is catastrophic: in Eq. (9), a necrotic channel contributes a constant $C_{kj} \times 1$ to every coupled neighbour, plus toxic noise that degrades neighbouring η_j. Left unaddressed, the necrotic source drives the global repair capacity $\eta(t)$ toward zero—the definition of *sepsis*.

A. Surgical intervention as topological truncation

When the necrotic channel satisfies Eq. (12) irreversibly and its coupling drag threatens systemic collapse, the only viable intervention is **topological truncation**: physically removing the necrotic node from the network.

Definition 2 (Topological truncation)**.** *Topological truncation is the application of* macroscopic external work *to sever all edges connecting a necrotic node to the network and to create a clean $\Gamma = 1$ boundary at the cut surface. In clinical practice: debridement, amputation, nephrectomy, limb-salvage resection.*

The physics of surgical truncation:

1. **Remove the noise source.** The necrotic channel's toxic emissions are eliminated from the ODE system.
2. **Create a clean boundary.** A surgically created $\Gamma = 1$ boundary reflects 100% of incident energy but produces *no toxic noise*—it is an honest open circuit, not a necrotic one.
3. **Release hijacked bandwidth.** The massive nociceptive crosstalk (Paper 1, Sec. 10 [2]) generated by the necrotic standing wave is terminated.
4. **Enable C2 recovery.** With the coupling drag removed, the global $\eta(t)$ stabilises, and surviving channels can resume repair per the recovery hierarchy of Sec. VIII.

Post-truncation, the brain's motor cortex faces a clean $\Gamma = 1$ boundary where the amputated limb was. If the cortex correctly detects this boundary and reduces $P_{\text{in}} \rightarrow 0$ (motor efference cessation), the reflected power vanishes and the network reaches a new, stable, albeit topologically reduced equilibrium. If the cortex continues to drive the severed channel—motor efference persists despite the open circuit—the reflected standing wave produces *phantom limb pain* (Paper 1 [2]): the same bandwidth-hijacking mechanism, now at a surgically created rather than pathologically created $\Gamma = 1$ boundary.

Remark 3 (The therapeutic hierarchy of intervention)**.** *The Γ-framework orders clinical interventions by the severity of the impedance failure they address:*

Regime	***Intervention***	Γ ***mechanism***
Pre-bifurcation	*Remove stressor*	*$s(t) \rightarrow 0$; η restores*
Post-bifurcation (single)	*Pharmacotherapy + psychotherapy*	*Push Γ_k^2 below saddle-node*
Post-bifurcation (multi)	*Simultaneous multi-modal*	*Multi-channel Γ_k^2 reset*
Necrotic	*Topological truncation (surgery)*	*Remove node; clean Γ=1 boundary*

No intervention outside this hierarchy is physically meaningful: you cannot C2-update a substrate that no longer

exists, and you cannot stressor-remove a bifurcation that is self-sustaining.

X. CAREGIVER TRIPLE-LOAD MODEL

Long-term caregivers experience three simultaneous Γ^2-injection channels with no comparable discharge path. Their impedance-debt rate is:

$$\frac{dD_Z}{dt} = \underbrace{\lambda\,\Gamma^2_{\text{other}}}_{\text{empathic load}} + \underbrace{\Gamma^2_{\text{moral}}}_{\text{moral constraint}} + \underbrace{\sigma\,s(t)}_{\text{daily stressor}} - \underbrace{\eta(t)\,\Gamma^2}_{\text{repair}}. \tag{13}$$

Channel 1: empathic load. Γ^2_{other} is the care-recipient's frozen mismatch (typically PTSD or dementia, $\Gamma^2 \approx 1$). The empathic coupling $\lambda > 0$ injects this energy into the caregiver's neural channel every contact hour; it cannot be "turned off" without severing the care relationship.

Channel 2: moral constraint. Social and internalised norms ("you must not give up") target the caregiver's fatigue pattern. Because the caregiver's η is already depleted, this pattern is approaching or inside $\mathcal{S}_{\text{eff}}$. By the Moral Constraint Theorem (Paper 1, Theorem 5 [2]), the demand injects $\Gamma^2_{\text{moral}} > 0$ with $\Delta Z_{\text{corrective}} = 0$—pure injury.

Channel 3: moral prohibition on λ-reduction. The only physically available knob for reducing dD_Z/dt is to lower λ (set boundaries, take breaks, delegate). Moral pressure *forbids* this adjustment ("abandonment"), locking the intake valve open.

Remark 4 (Structural inevitability of caregiver disease)**.** *In Eq. (13), the first three terms are approximately constant or increasing (the care-recipient's Γ^2 does not spontaneously decrease; moral pressure does not spontaneously relent; daily stress persists). The repair term $\eta(t)\,\Gamma^2$ decreases because $\eta(t)$ declines by Arrhenius kinetics and is further depressed by cortisol-mediated hippocampal atrophy. Therefore $dD_Z/dt > 0$ for all future time—the deficit is* structurally guaranteed *to widen. The resulting disease cascade (Eq. 9, Fig. 1) is not a risk factor but a mathematical inevitability unless institutional intervention (shift rotation, λ-reduction protocols) is applied.*

Remark 5 (Compassion fatigue, burnout, vicarious trauma: one equation, three names)**.** *Clinical nomenclature distinguishes compassion fatigue, burnout, and vicarious trauma as separate syndromes. Within Eq. (13) they are three regimes of the same physics:*

Syndrome	*Dominant term*	*$\mathcal{S}_{eff}$ status*
Burnout	$\sigma\,s(t)$ *(workload)*	*not yet sealed*
Compassion fatigue	$\lambda\,\Gamma^2_{other}$	*approaching seal*
Vicarious trauma	$\lambda\,\Gamma^2_{other}$ *sealed*	*sealed*

The physical distinction is whether the dominant Γ^2 pattern has entered $\mathcal{S}_{eff}$: if not, rest and workload reduction suffice (burnout); if sealed, only pharmacological η-elevation plus guided C2 gradient (combined therapy) can rewrite the pattern— identical to the PTSD treatment protocol (Paper 3, Sec. 13b.2 [4]).

XI. SURFACE OBSERVABILITY: SKIN AS IMPEDANCE BOUNDARY

When $dD_Z/dt > 0$ persists, the accumulated impedance debt diffuses through the organ coupling matrix C_{kj}:

$$\text{Neural} \xrightarrow{C_{21}} \text{Vascular} \xrightarrow{C_{42}} \text{Metabolic} \rightarrow \text{Surface}$$

The full observable chain is:

$$\underbrace{\text{Neural}\ \Gamma^2_n\uparrow}_{\text{mood, cognition}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\text{HPA / ANS}}_{\text{sleep, appetite, temper}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\text{Vascular}\ \Gamma^2_v\uparrow}_{\text{micro-circulation}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\text{Metaboli}}_{\text{collagen,}}$$

Remark 6 (Empathic overload as single-core running dual-core load)**.** *The empath's Γ-network physically simulates another person's pain state: her own daily mismatch load $\sigma\,s(t)$ remains, while the empathic channel adds $\lambda\,\Gamma^2_{other}$—effectively doubling the total Γ^2 input on a single repair budget $\eta(t)$. This is analogous to a single-core processor forced to sustain a dual-core workload.*

Skin is not an isolated organ but the *outermost boundary condition* of the whole-body impedance network. It simultaneously receives the output state of vascular, metabolic, and immune channels:

Internal Γ^2 channel	Skin manifestation	Colloquial
Vascular $\Gamma^2_v\uparrow$	Pallor, dark circles, dull complexion	"Bad colo
Metabolic $\Gamma^2_{\text{met}}\uparrow$	Roughness, sallowness	"Poor skin
Immune $\Gamma^2_{\text{imm}}\uparrow$	Redness, hypersensitivity	"Skin dete

A third party's intuitive visual assessment—"You look worn out"—can be re-read as a low-resolution impedance tomography scan. The observer's cortex holds an internal template Z_{healthy}; when the observed surface impedance Z_{obs} deviates significantly, the visual reflection coefficient

$$\Gamma_{\text{visual}} = \frac{Z_{\text{obs}} - Z_{\text{healthy}}}{Z_{\text{obs}} + Z_{\text{healthy}}} \neq 0 \tag{14}$$

is read out as "something looks off."

Remark 7 (Downstream convergence)**.** *Empathic load ($\lambda\Gamma^2_{other}$ dominant) and occupational stress ($\sigma\,s(t)$ dominant) differ only in their* upstream *input channel. Once Γ^2 enters the coupling matrix C_{kj}, the subsequent path is identical. From the skin's perspective as terminal load they are branches of the same Γ-disease tree.*

XII. OBESITY AS IMPEDANCE-DRIVEN METABOLIC STRATEGY

Conventional discourse frames obesity as a failure of self-control. The Γ-framework reveals a different causal structure: chronic Γ^2 overload triggers a whole-body metabolic reallocation that makes overeating a *physically rational* compensatory strategy.

a. Selfish-brain cascade. Under sustained stress, the brain's privileged topological hub draws disproportionate power flux. In the Γ-language:

$$\text{High } \Gamma_n^2 \xrightarrow{\text{HPA axis}} \text{insulin/glucose redistribution} \xrightarrow{\text{reward}} \text{appetite}\uparrow,\ \text{satiety sensitivity}\downarrow \tag{15}$$

b. Leptin resistance as impedance mismatch. In sustained obesity, circulating leptin is high, but the hypothalamic leptin-receptor pathway exhibits reduced signal transmission—a textbook impedance mismatch. The leptin channel's reflection coefficient $\Gamma_{\text{leptin}} = (Z_{\text{hypothalamus}} - Z_{\text{leptin}})/(Z_{\text{hypothalamus}} + Z_{\text{leptin}}) \to 1$ approaches unity: the signal is almost totally reflected.

c. Hedonic eating as short-term Γ^2 reduction. High-calorie intake produces a transient subjective Γ^2 reduction ("comfort"), trading a brief mismatch relief for a larger long-term D_Z increment:

$$\underbrace{\Delta\Gamma^2_{\text{short}} < 0}_{\text{hedonic relief}}, \quad \underbrace{\Delta D_{Z,\text{long}} \gg 0}_{\text{metabolic debt}}$$

This is the metabolic analogue of the PTSD flashback–avoidance cycle (Paper 3).

Remark 8 (Moral blame as secondary metabolic injury)**.** *Applying the Moral Constraint Theorem (Paper 1, Theorem 5 [2]) to the obese individual: the eating pattern is already approaching or inside $\mathcal{S}_{eff}$, so moral condemnation ("lack of self-discipline") injects Γ^2_{blame} without any corresponding $\Delta Z_{corrective}$. The result is strictly additional impedance debt: the subject now carries the original metabolic* Γ^2 plus *a shame/stigma Γ^2 that further activates the stress–appetite cascade, accelerating the very pathology it purports to correct. Weight-stigma research confirms precisely this paradox [7].*

Remark 9 (Positive-feedback closure: obesity as mathematical attractor)**.** *The metabolic cascade of Eq. (15) is a* closed positive-feedback loop*:*

$$\textit{Metabolic } \Gamma^2\uparrow \to \textit{ peripheral deterioration } \to \textit{ neural detection } \to \textit{ energy reallocation } \to \textit{ appetite}\uparrow \to \textit{ Metabolic } \Gamma^2\uparrow$$

As long as environmental stress persists, the loop gain exceeds unity and cumulative weight gain is a fixed-point attractor *of the coupled dynamics.*

Remark 10 (Skin disease as metabolic×immune interface projection)**.** *Skin is the terminal load on the vascular, metabolic, and immune bus. Its impedance Z_{skin} is coupled to internal channels via C_{kj}:*

$$\Gamma^2_{skin} = \Gamma^2_{skin,local} + C_{skin,met}\Gamma^2_m + C_{skin,imm}\Gamma^2_{imm}.$$

Metabolic syndrome and immune activation share the same chronic-inflammation mediators (IL-6, TNF-α), which couple through the blood stream to the dermal interface. Psoriasis, eczema, and acne are therefore not "skin problems" but visible readouts *of internal Γ^2 projected onto the highest-surface-area interface. Treatment targeting only the skin (topicals, emollients) reduces $\Gamma^2_{skin,local}$ but leaves the dominant metabolic and immune terms intact—explaining chronic relapse.*

Remark 11 (Gut–liver–metabolic C3 relay chain)**.** *The intestinal (#8), hepatic (#12), adipose (#14), and endocrine (#9) channels form a strongly coupled subsystem—the "gut–liver–metabolic axis"—that functions as a C3 relay chain:*

$$\underbrace{\textit{food/microbiome}}_{\textit{GI interface}} \to \underbrace{\textit{liver, adipose, pancreas}}_{\textit{metabolic channels}} \to \underbrace{\textit{feedback to GI wal}}_{\textit{Z-change \& symptoms}}$$

*Any segment operating at high Γ^2 produces reflected energy that propagates bidirectionally: hepatic steatosis raises Γ^2_{hep}, altering bile composition (Remark **??**, Paper 3) and downstream fat absorption; gut dysbiosis raises Γ^2_{gut}, increasing portal endotoxin load to the liver. The entire axis is a single impedance cascade whose clinical manifestations (IBS, NAFLD, type 2 diabetes, PCOS) are projections of the same underlying Γ^2 distribution.*

Remark 12 (Lymphatic blockade as positive-feedback cascade)**.** *Adipose tissue expansion increases the mechanical and immunological load on lymph nodes (channel #10). Three coupled mechanisms drive a positive-feedback loop:*

1. ***Load**: chronic inflammation enlarges lymph nodes (reactive hypertrophy, Table **??**).*
2. ***Flow**: adipose compression and chronic inflammation reduce lymphatic contractility and increase vessel permeability—raising Γ^2_{lymph}.*
3. ***Closure**: impaired lymphatic drainage increases interstitial fluid and inflammatory mediators, which further stimulate node hypertrophy and vessel fibrosis.*

The loop gain exceeds unity when body fat reaches a critical threshold. Clinical manifestations include limb oedema, lymphoedema, increased infection susceptibility, and impaired wound healing—all of which increase Γ^2 in other channels, feeding the metabolic cascade.

Remark 13 (Bile–metabolic–vascular–skin: the closed pathology loop)**.** *Combining Remark **??** (Paper 3, bile relay), Remark 11 (gut–liver axis), Remark 12 (lymphatic blockade), and Remark 10 (skin projection) yields a single closed loop:*

$$\textit{bile quality}\downarrow \to \Gamma^2_m\uparrow \to \textit{ fat/liver load}\uparrow \to \textit{ bile secretion altered } \to$$

*Each traversal accumulates D_Z in every coupled channel (vascular, skin, lymphatic, immune). The "sallow, fatigued" phenotype is the observable fixed-point of this loop—not a single organ's failure but the equilibrium state of the whole coupled system. Breaking the loop requires simultaneous intervention at multiple impedance nodes: dietary substrate quality (bile input), exercise (vascular η increase), and hydration (Remark **??**, Paper 3). No single-channel treatment is sufficient when the loop gain exceeds unity.*

Remark 14 (Metabolic–neural closure: a C3–coupled physical necessity)**.** *The metabolic cascades above close to the neural network through the coupling matrix C_{kj}, forming a complete loop:*

$$\underbrace{\textit{Metabolic}\ \Gamma^2_m\uparrow}_{\textit{fat, liver, bile}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\textit{Lymph blockade}\ \Gamma^2_{lymph}\uparrow}_{\textit{waste channel}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\textit{Micro-circ.}\ \Gamma^2_{\rho}\uparrow}_{\textit{material channel}}$$

$$\rightarrow \underbrace{\textit{Neural}\ \Gamma^2_n\uparrow,\ D_Z\uparrow}_{\textit{supply deficit}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\textit{Reward C2 rewrite}}_{\textit{"learn wrong"}} \rightarrow \underbrace{\textit{Behaviour}\ \uparrow\textit{sugar},\ \downarrow\textit{exercise}}_{\textit{error compensation}} \rightarrow \textit{Metabolic}\ \Gamma^2_m\uparrow$$

This closure is not an assumption but a physical necessity*: the neural and vascular buses connect every organ through bifurcation and low-K relay neurons (Paper 2, Remark **??**). Any persistent Γ^2 elevation in the metabolic subsystem inevitably propagates to the neural bus via C3 dimensional relay, because the vascular tree's ρ-supply and the autonomic tree's control signals share the same inter-organ topology. The neural network, once affected, rewrites its C2 weights on the reward channel—encoding the compensatory behaviour (hedonic eating, sedentarism) as a learned Z-pattern that further elevates metabolic load. The loop gain exceeds unity when both the metabolic and neural channels have individually crossed their bifurcation thresholds ($\lambda_+ > 0$ in Eq. 18). At that point, the cycle is self-sustaining and no single-channel intervention suffices (Theorem 3).*

Remark 15 ("Willpower" as $\eta_{\rm pfc}(t)$: a depleting physical quantity)**.** *What common discourse calls "willpower" corresponds to the prefrontal repair rate $\eta_{pfc}(t)$. But the prefrontal cortex is itself a channel within the same impedance network; its $\eta_{pfc}(t)$ decays by the same Arrhenius kinetics and is further depressed by the chronic cortisol load:*

$$\eta_{pfc}(t) = \eta_0\, e^{-E_a/k_BT}\cdot f_{cortisol}(D_Z(t)) \xrightarrow[\textit{chronic}\ \Gamma^2]{} \textit{depleted}$$

Asking a chronically stressed individual to "simply exercise self-control" is a request to draw on a resource that the physics has already consumed.

Proposition 1 (Non-existence of free willpower: proof by contradiction from psychiatric epidemiology)**.** Claim. *"Willpower" is not a free parameter of the human system.*

Proof. *Suppose, for contradiction, that willpower were a freely available override—i.e. that every agent possesses an unbounded η_{pfc} capable of suppressing any Γ^2 pattern at any time. Then no mismatch could persist against the agent's intention, and* no mental illness could exist*. Empirically, approximately 970 million people worldwide carry a diagnosed mental disorder (WHO, 2019). Contradiction. Therefore willpower is a state-dependent, depletable physical quantity $\eta_{pfc}(t)$, subject to the same decay as every other channel.* □

XIII. IMMUNE–METABOLIC BIDIRECTIONAL FEEDBACK: THE INFLAMMATION–INSULIN TRAP

Among the off-diagonal entries of the coupling matrix C_{kj}, the pair $(C_{\rm imm,met}, C_{\rm met,imm})$ deserves independent analysis because *both* are positive and mutually reinforcing.

Write the two-channel subsystem:

$$\frac{d\Gamma^2_{\rm imm}}{dt} = -\eta\,\Gamma^2_{\rm imm} + C_{\rm imm,met}\,\Gamma^2_{\rm met} + \beta_{\rm imm}\,\Gamma^4_{\rm imm}\,, \quad (16)$$

$$\frac{d\Gamma^2_{\rm met}}{dt} = -\eta\,\Gamma^2_{\rm met} + C_{\rm met,imm}\,\Gamma^2_{\rm imm} + \beta_{\rm met}\,\Gamma^4_{\rm met}\,. \quad (17)$$

The mutual-excitation terms form a closed cycle: adipocyte hypertrophy → macrophage infiltration → pro-inflammatory cytokines → impaired insulin signalling → further metabolic Γ^2 rise.

Linearising about equilibrium, the Jacobian eigenvalues are

$$\lambda_\pm = -\eta + \tfrac{1}{2}\big(\alpha_{\rm imm}+\alpha_{\rm met}\big) \pm \sqrt{C_{\rm imm,met}\,C_{\rm met,imm} + \tfrac{1}{4}(\alpha_{\rm imm}-\alpha_{\rm met})^2} \quad (18)$$

where $\alpha_k \equiv 2\beta_k\,\Gamma^2_{k,\rm eq}$. The subsystem destabilises when $\lambda_+ > 0$:

$$\sqrt{C_{\rm imm,met}\,C_{\rm met,imm}} > \eta - \tfrac{1}{2}(\alpha_{\rm imm}+\alpha_{\rm met})\,. \quad (19)$$

This is the *inflammation–insulin trap*: once the geometric mean of the mutual coupling exceeds the net repair margin, the two channels lock into a self-sustaining high-Γ^2 fixed point—metabolic syndrome with chronic inflammation—even if the original neural stressor has been removed.

This explains why bariatric surgery (which mechanically breaks the metabolic $\beta_{\rm met}\,\Gamma^4$ term) can resolve both diabetes *and* systemic inflammation simultaneously—a dual-channel reset that diet alone often cannot achieve.

XIV. TYPE 2 DIABETES AS GLOBAL IMPEDANCE DRIFT

A. Insulin signalling as impedance matching

The insulin–glucose regulatory loop is a *negative feedback impedance servo.* Pancreatic β-cells secrete insulin (the "source") at impedance Z_β; peripheral cells present

insulin receptors (the "load") at impedance Z_R. Define the receptor impedance:

$$Z_R = \frac{Z_0}{K_d \cdot N_R}\,, \tag{20}$$

where Z_0 is a tissue-type normalisation constant, N_R is receptor density, and K_d is binding affinity. Insulin resistance is a continuous drift: either $N_R \downarrow$ or $K_d \uparrow$ raises Z_R, increasing Γ^2_{ins} monotonically.

B. C2 update of receptor impedance

Unlike neural channels, the insulin–receptor system operates as a *chemical bath*: insulin is broadcast systemically. A chronic stressor (elevated cortisol) acts as a *global* x_{in} that drives C2 update on every peripheral receptor simultaneously:

$$\frac{dZ_R}{dt} = \underbrace{-\eta_R\,\Gamma_{\text{ins}}\,x_{\text{ins}}\,x_{\text{glucose}}}_{\text{C2 repair (toward } Z_\beta)} + \underbrace{\alpha_c\,\Gamma^2_{\text{cortisol}}\,Z_R}_{\text{cortisol-driven upregulation}}\,, \tag{21}$$

where η_R is the receptor repair rate and α_c is the cortisol coupling coefficient. The first term is standard C2; the second is the cortisol *counter-gradient* that pushes Z_R upward faster than η_R can pull it down.

C. The insulin resistance lock: bifurcation analysis

As Γ^2_{ins} rises, less glucose is cleared, hyperglycaemia develops, and the pancreas compensates by secreting more insulin. Elevated insulin drives receptor downregulation ($N_R \downarrow$), further raising Z_R:

$$\frac{dN_R}{dt} = -\kappa\,[\text{insulin}]\,N_R + \sigma_R\,(N_{R,0} - N_R)\,, \tag{22}$$

where κ is the internalisation rate and σ_R the receptor synthesis rate.

The bifurcation condition is:

$$\frac{\kappa\,[\text{insulin}]}{K_d\,N_R^2} > \frac{\eta_R}{Z_0}\,. \tag{23}$$

Once the product of hyperinsulinaemia and receptor internalisation rate exceeds the repair margin, the system is locked in a high-Γ^2_{ins} attractor—insulin resistance is structurally irreversible under the current η_R.

Remark 16 (Why diet alone often fails)**.** *Caloric restriction reduces $x_{glucose}$, which weakens the C2 repair term in Eq. (21). If the cortisol term remains elevated (chronic stress persists), dZ_R/dt may remain positive* despite caloric deficit—*the receptor impedance continues to drift upward even as the patient loses weight. This resolves the clinical paradox of patients who achieve significant weight loss yet remain insulin-resistant.*

D. The six-channel T2DM cascade

Once Γ^2_{ins} crosses the bifurcation threshold (Eq. 23), the coupled dynamics propagate through six channels:

1. **Neural → Endocrine**: Chronic stress raises $\Gamma^2_{\text{cortisol}}$—the initiating event.
2. **Endocrine → Metabolic**: $\Gamma^2_{\text{ins}} \to 1$; glucose clearance collapses; hepatic lipogenesis accelerates.
3. **Metabolic → Immune**: Adipocyte hypertrophy triggers macrophage infiltration (IL-6, TNF-α).
4. **Immune → Vascular**: Chronic inflammation damages endothelial function; arterial compliance drops.
5. **Vascular → Renal**: Elevated vascular Γ^2 reduces glomerular perfusion; RAAS activates.
6. **Renal → Neural**: Uraemic toxins impair neural repair η_n, closing the loop.

The complete cascade forms a closed hexagonal coupling:

$$\text{Neu} \xrightarrow{C_{\text{end,neu}}} \text{End} \xrightarrow{C_{\text{met,end}}} \text{Met} \xrightarrow{C_{\text{imm,met}}} \text{Imm} \xrightarrow{C_{\text{vas,imm}}} \text{Vas} \xrightarrow{C_{\text{ren,vas}}} \text{Ren} \tag{24}$$

Once any *two* adjacent channels are locked, single-channel intervention is provably insufficient:

$$\eta_k\,\Gamma_k^2 < \sum_{j\neq k} C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2 + \beta_k\,\Gamma_k^4 \quad \forall\, k \in \text{locked channels}. \tag{25}$$

Theorem 3 (T2DM treatment minimum: multi-channel simultaneous intervention)**.** *Let $\mathcal{L} \subseteq \{1,\ldots,6\}$ be the set of channels that have individually crossed their bifurcation thresholds in the T2DM hexagon (Eq. 24). A therapeutic protocol can reduce Γ_k^2 below threshold for all $k \in \mathcal{L}$ only if it targets at least $|\mathcal{L}|$ channels simultaneously.*

Proof. By Eq. (25), each locked channel $k \in \mathcal{L}$ satisfies $d\Gamma_k^2/dt > 0$ due to the coupling $C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2$ from neighbouring locked channels. Unlocking channel k alone reduces Γ_k^2 transiently, but the coupling term $C_{kj}\,\Gamma_j^2$ from the remaining $j \in \mathcal{L}\backslash\{k\}$ re-elevates Γ_k^2 above threshold within $\tau_{\text{relapse}} \sim C_{kj}/\eta_k$ ticks. This argument applies symmetrically to every $k \in \mathcal{L}$. Only simultaneous reduction of all Γ_j^2 for $j \in \mathcal{L}$ removes the mutual sustenance condition, allowing each channel to descend below threshold under its own C2 gradient. Therefore any successful protocol must target at least $|\mathcal{L}|$ channels simultaneously. □ □

This theorem explains why T2DM management improves dramatically under "lifestyle medicine" protocols that combine dietary change (metabolic), exercise (vascular + metabolic), stress reduction (neural + endocrine), and anti-inflammatory agents (immune)—each targeting a different vertex of the hexagon.

Remark 17 (β-cell exhaustion as impedance substrate collapse)**.** *In advanced T2DM, compensatory hyperinsulinaemia eventually exhausts β-cell secretory capacity: $Z_\beta \to \infty$ (cell death). This is the metabolic analogue of tissue necrosis (Sec. IX): the substrate that* generates *the source impedance is destroyed. At this stage, T2DM functionally converges with T1DM—not because the aetiology is the same, but because the* topological endpoint *is identical: $Z_\beta = \infty$, $\Gamma_{ins} = 1$, $T_{ins} = 0$. Exogenous insulin injection replaces the destroyed source.*

XV. ACUTE VERSUS CHRONIC STRESS: BIFURCATION THRESHOLD UNDER TIME-LIMITED FORCING

Consider a square-pulse stressor of amplitude A and duration Δt:

$$s(t) = A\left[\Theta(t) - \Theta(t - \Delta t)\right]. \tag{26}$$

During the pulse, the channel trajectories satisfy

$$\Gamma_k^2(t) \approx \Gamma_{k,\mathrm{eq}} + \frac{\sigma_k A}{\eta}\left(1 - e^{-\eta t}\right) \tag{27}$$

to first order. The system remains safe provided

$$\Gamma_{k,\mathrm{eq}} + \frac{\sigma_k A}{\eta} < \Gamma_k^{*2} \quad \text{(bifurcation threshold)}. \tag{28}$$

This is the physics of *beneficial acute stress*: high-intensity exercise, cold-water immersion, intermittent fasting—all push Γ_k^2 transiently upward, stimulating C2 repair ("hormesis"), and the system returns to baseline before coupling or positive feedback can engage.

Chronic stress ($s(t) = a$ for $t \gg 1/\eta$) gives a steady-state solution:

$$\Gamma_{k,\mathrm{ss}}^2 = \frac{\sigma_k a + \sum_j C_{kj}\Gamma_{j,\mathrm{ss}}^2 + \delta_k}{\eta - \beta_k \Gamma_{k,\mathrm{ss}}^2}. \tag{29}$$

The saddle-node bifurcation occurs at

$$\eta = \beta_k \Gamma_k^{*2} + \frac{\partial}{\partial \Gamma_k^2}\sum_j C_{kj}\Gamma_j^2, \tag{30}$$

a threshold that *decreases* with age (because $\eta(t)$ declines by Arrhenius kinetics while $\delta_k(t)$ grows).

Remark 18 (The exercise paradox resolved)**.** *Exercise is simultaneously a high-Γ^2 perturbation and the most effective known intervention against chronic disease. The paradox dissolves once time scale is explicit: exercise is* acute *forcing ($\Delta t \sim 1$ hour, then $s \to 0$) that never reaches the bifurcation threshold (Eq. 28), while the transient Γ^2 elevation* stimulates *C2 remodeling—raising effective η in vascular and metabolic channels. Chronic sedentary stress, by contrast, is low-amplitude but* never turns off. *Exercise is therapeutic precisely because it is* intermittent and bounded.

Part D: E0 Emergence — Disease from Topology Alone

XVI. E0 EMERGENCE: DISEASE FROM TOPOLOGY ALONE

We define three emergence levels:

- **E0 (True Emergence)**: only C1/C2/C3 + initial conditions. Zero disease-specific flags, thresholds, or formulas.
- **E1 (Parameterised)**: C2 via `ImpedanceChannel.remodel()` with per-disease parameters (Z_{coeff}, severity).
- **E2 (Scripted)**: ad-hoc Z updates. Legacy only; forbidden for new code.

E0 is the gold standard: "if you need a flag, it didn't emerge."

A. Cardiovascular E0: hypertension, MI, aortic stenosis

Starting from a healthy 11-node cardiovascular `GammaTopology` ($K \in \{4, 2, 1\}$; Paper 1 [2]):

1. **Hypertension**: arteriolar $Z \times 2.0 \Rightarrow \Gamma^2$ at aorta→arterioles increases; C2 partially compensates over 300 ticks.
2. **Myocardial infarction**: sever aorta→coronary edge ⇒ coronary node isolated; topology structurally different from HTN (correlation < 0.99).
3. **Aortic stenosis**: valve $Z \times 3.0 \Rightarrow$ LV-to-aorta Γ^2 increases.
4. **Dose–response**: arteriolar Z-factor $\{1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 3.0\}$ yields monotonically increasing Γ^2.

Thirteen automated tests (`tests/test_e0_cardiovascular.py`), 100% pass. No disease model was coded; pathology identity is determined solely by the perturbation type and magnitude.

B. Neural E0: ALS, stroke, PTSD, phantom pain

Starting from a healthy 9-node neural `GammaTopology` ($K \in \{5, 3, 2, 1\}$; Paper 1 [2]):

1. **ALS** (motor neuron $Z \times 3.0$): cumulative A_{imp} over 30 ticks is $2.9\times$ healthy; C2 partially compensates.

2. **Stroke** (cortex→thalamus edge severed): descending motor transmission interrupted; ascending sensory pathway spared—topologically determined.

3. **PTSD** (nociceptor C driven at 5× normal amplitude for 100 ticks, then stopped): residual mismatch ($\varepsilon \approx 1$) persists, locked in $\mathcal{S}_{\text{eff}}$. Quiet environments lower P_{noise}, causing submerged traces to breach θ_{recall} explosively—the "flashback."

4. **Phantom limb pain** (motor neuron→nociceptor edge severed): efferent modulation lost; ascending pain pathway remains intact.

Seventeen automated tests (`tests/test_e0_neural.py`), 100% pass. Additional tests verify: ALS vs. stroke produce distinguishable trajectories; severity dose–response is monotonic; $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$ at all times (irreducibility); A_{imp} decreases under C2 (learnable).

C. Implications

Theorem 4 (E0 Emergence)**.** *Let $\mathcal{N}$ be a network topology satisfying C1/C2/C3 with biologically realistic initial conditions (Z_0, K, η, δ). Then clinical pathology—including cardiovascular, neural, thermal, and sleep-disorder phenotypes—arises as a necessary consequence of impedance dynamics on $\mathcal{N}$, without any disease-specific flags, thresholds, or scoring systems.*

Proof by construction. We instantiate 29 tissue-type blueprints with biologically motivated (Z_0, K, η, δ) parameters and run C1/C2/C3 dynamics under perturbation. The resulting Γ-distributions reproduce recognised clinical phenotypes across cardiovascular (13 tests), neural (17 tests), and 245 parametrised blueprint tests, totalling 275 automated E0 tests with 100% pass rate. Each test verifies: (i) $\Gamma^2 + T = 1$ (C1 conservation); (ii) A_{imp} decreases under C2; (iii) $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$ (irreducibility); (iv) clinically recognisable phenotype emerges. Source: `tests/test_e0_*.py`. □

The 275 E0 tests (245 parametrised blueprint tests + 13 cardiovascular + 17 neural disease tests) across all 29 organ-system topologies prove that clinical pathology *can* emerge from pure impedance physics—C1/C2/C3 plus initial conditions—on biologically realistic tissue topologies. No disease-specific code, no flags, no thresholds, no scoring systems. The disease *is* the perturbation; the clinical pattern *is* the resulting Γ-distribution.

Corollary 3 (Disease identity as topological fingerprint)**.** *Two perturbations that produce identical Γ-distributions across the network topology are the same disease, regardless of their molecular aetiology. Two perturbations that produce distinguishable Γ-distributions are distinct diseases, even if they share the same molecular pathway.*

Corollary 4 (Irreversibility threshold)**.** *A topological perturbation is clinically irreversible if and only if the resulting Γ-distribution satisfies $A_{cut}^{new} > A_{cut}^{healthy}$— i.e., the cutoff action has increased. C2 can reduce $A_{imp} \to 0$ but cannot reduce A_{cut}; therefore any increase in A_{cut} is permanent without topological intervention (surgery, ablation, or structural restoration).*

D. Thermal loop collapse: hypothermia and hyperthermia

Paper 3 [4] derives the $\Gamma^2 \leftrightarrow T$ self-consistent loop. The 37 °C operating point is the stable fixed point. When the loop is driven outside its basin of attraction, two E0 pathologies emerge:

	Hypothermia	**Hyperthermia**
Direction	$T \ll T^*$	$T \gg T^*$
Primary driver	$\eta(T)\uparrow$ (viscosity)	$k_B T\uparrow$ (noise)
Γ mechanism	$Z_{\text{bus}}\uparrow \to \Gamma^2\uparrow$	$\delta\Gamma/\Gamma \propto K^{3/2}\delta T/T$
First failure	Global Γ^2 rise	PFC (K=5) first
Clinical sign	Bradycardia → coma	Delirium → seizure
Feedback	Positive (less heat → colder)	Positive (more noise –
C2 repair	Slowed (Arrhenius ↓)	Overwhelmed (noise >

Both are **E0**: they arise from C1/C2/C3 plus the Arrhenius temperature dependence of Z_{bus} and η_{learn}—no pathology-specific parameters. The clinical asymmetry (hypothermia is global; hyperthermia hits PFC first) is a direct consequence of the $K^{3/2}$ thermal vulnerability derived in Paper 1 [2].

E. Sleep disorders as gate-leak pathology

Paper 3 [4] derives the gate-leak inequality:

$$G_i^2\, \Gamma_i^2\, P_{\text{in},i} \;>\; 4\, k_B T\, R_{\text{eff}}\, \Delta f \;\equiv\; P_\theta \qquad \text{(P3, Eq. 10)}$$

as the physical condition for forced awakening. Three clinically distinct sleep disorders map onto three different structural failures within this single inequality:

a. Insomnia: Γ_i^2 overload. Chronic stress forges one or more channels at high structural mismatch ($\Gamma_i^2 \gg \langle\Gamma^2\rangle$). The thalamic gate G_i is at its physical minimum, yet the leaked power exceeds P_θ. Pharmacological intervention (e.g. benzodiazepines) temporarily increases gate attenuation; durable resolution requires C2 update of the underlying Γ_i^2 (CBT-I provides the sustained counter-signal).

b. Narcolepsy: Z_{anchor} loss. The orexin system provides the structural anchor Z_{anchor} that prevents Z_{arousal} from drifting below threshold. Autoimmune destruction of orexin neurons eliminates this anchor; Z_{arousal} becomes a random walk that crosses threshold at unpredictable intervals → sleep attacks. Cataplexy is the motor-gate

analogue: a limbic Γ^2 spike leaks through the descending motor gate.

c. Hypersomnia: β_{recal} deficit. Idiopathic hypersomnia preserves the arousal anchor but has a structurally low NREM recalibration rate. Impedance debt D_Z is never fully discharged; elevated baseline $\langle\Gamma^2\rangle$ means any small increase in P_{in} tips a channel past P_θ $\rightarrow$ excessive daytime sleepiness.

d. Unified diagnostic map.

Disorder	Broken parameter	Gate-leak status	Treatment target
Insomnia	Γ_i^2 too high	Cannot close	Lower Γ_i^2 (CBT-I)
Narcolepsy	$Z_{\text{anchor}} \rightarrow 0$	Collapses suddenly	Restore anchor
Hypersomnia	β_{recal} low	Barely holding	Raise β_{recal}

All three disorders are *structural* impedance failures unified under a single gate-leak equation. The clinical fact that insomnia and hypersomnia often coexist ("tired but wired") maps naturally to a system where β_{recal} is low *and* one channel has high Γ_i^2.

XVII. DISCUSSION

This paper has established that disease is not an external overlay on physiology but a *necessary consequence* of impedance physics when the network is perturbed beyond its repair capacity. The key results are:

First, neural pathology is topologically determined (Part A): stroke, ALS, neurodegeneration, and pain are all instances of the irreducibility theorem applied to perturbed networks. C2 can repair impedance perturbations but is blind to topological damage (A_{cut}).

Second, the dual-network disease cascade (Part B) shows that vascular and neural failure are not independent: the five-step positive-feedback loop (Eq. 4) drives co-failure, and all major vascular diseases—atherosclerosis, aneurysm, diabetic microvascular disease, vascular dementia, pre-eclampsia—are instances of this cascade at different anatomical loci. Wound repair is the spatial-domain realisation of Γ^2 minimisation.

Third, the coupled five-organ ODE (Eq. 9) produces disease onset as a phase transition (Remark 1), recovery as a three-regime bifurcation problem (Sec. VIII), and necrosis as irreversible substrate collapse (Definition 1). The therapeutic hierarchy (Remark 3) follows directly from the bifurcation structure.

Fourth, the complete physics of type 2 diabetes has been derived from C2 alone: receptor impedance drift (Eq. 21), bifurcation lock (Eq. 23), and six-channel hexagonal deadlock (Theorem 3).

Fifth, 275 automated E0 tests across 29 tissue topologies (Part D) demonstrate that clinical pathology can emerge from C1/C2/C3 plus initial conditions alone.

The question is no longer "Does C2 apply to tissue X?" The question is: "What stops C2 from applying to tissue X?" If nothing stops it, then tissue X updates via C2. And nothing stops it.

XVIII. CONCLUSION

We have established five results.

First, neural pathology is determined by network topology: the irreducibility theorem predicts that topological damage (A_{cut}) is permanent while impedance damage (A_{imp}) is repairable—verified for stroke, ALS, neurodegeneration, and phantom pain.

Second, the dual-network positive-feedback cascade (Eq. 4) unifies atherosclerosis, aneurysm, diabetic microvascular disease, vascular dementia, and pre-eclampsia as instances of the same vascular–neural co-failure at different anatomical loci.

Third, coupled five-organ dynamics (Eq. 9) produce disease onset as a saddle-node phase transition, with three recovery regimes (reversible, single-channel locked, multi-channel locked) and tissue necrosis as irreversible substrate collapse (Eq. 12). The therapeutic hierarchy—from stressor removal through pharmacotherapy to topological truncation— is a direct consequence of the bifurcation structure.

Fourth, type 2 diabetes is a six-channel hexagonal deadlock (Eq. 24; Theorem 3): single-channel therapy provably cannot break a multi-channel lock, explaining the clinical superiority of combined lifestyle interventions.

Fifth, 275 E0 tests across 29 tissue topologies prove that clinical pathology emerges from C1/C2/C3 plus initial conditions alone—no disease-specific code, flags, or scoring systems.

The Γ-framework does not *model* disease; it derives disease as a mathematical inevitability when impedance networks are pushed beyond their repair capacity.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This work used no external funding. The author thanks Claude (Anthropic) for extended discussions that clarified the universality of the disease-cascade framework across tissue types.

[1] H.-Y. Huang, "The Γ-Net Framework: Axioms, Derived Quantities, and Experimental Validation Matrix," Zenodo (2026), Paper 0 of this series.

[2] H.-Y. Huang, "Irreducible Dimensional Cost, Brain Ar-

chitecture, and the Physics of Mind on the Γ-Net," arXiv (2026), Paper 1.

[3] H.-Y. Huang, "Dual Neural–Vascular Networks from Impedance Matching: Murray's Law, Organ Health, and Metabolic Scaling," arXiv (2026), Paper 2.

[4] H.-Y. Huang, "Temporal Dynamics and Universal Update: Impedance Debt, Sleep, Lifecycle, Aging, and Twenty-Nine C2 Networks," arXiv (2026), Paper 3.

[5] H.-Y. Huang, "Full System Verification: NHANES Validation, Network Propagation, and Falsifiable Predictions," arXiv (2026), Paper 5.

[6] A. Peters *et al.*, "The selfish brain: competition for energy resources," *Neurosci. Biobehav. Rev.* **28**, 143 (2004).

[7] A. R. Sutin and A. Terracciano, "Perceived weight discrimination and obesity," *PLoS ONE* **8**, e70048 (2013).

[8] S. E. Kahn, R. L. Hull, and K. M. Utzschneider, "Mechanisms linking obesity to insulin resistance and type 2 diabetes," *Nature* **444**, 840 (2006).

[9] C. P. Moran and F. Shanahan, "Leptin resistance and obesity," in *Textbook of Energy Balance* (Springer, 2019).

[10] H. Schellekens, T. G. Dinan, and J. F. Cryan, "Lean mean fat reducing 'ghrelin' machine," *Neuropharmacology* **63**, 3 (2012).

[11] J. M. Friedman, "Leptin and the endocrine control of energy balance," *Nature Metab.* **1**, 754 (2019).

[12] J. E. Hall and M. E. Hall, *Guyton and Hall Textbook of Medical Physiology*, 14th ed. (Elsevier, 2020).

[13] H.-Y. Huang, ALICE Smart System, `https://github.com/cyhuang76/alice-gamma-net` (2026). doi:10.5281/zenodo.18852835